

# What They Don't Tell You About Creating Music in the Age of AI

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One Independent Artist's Journey from Song Idea to Release

By Shelly Cool

Singer • Songwriter • Producer • Educator

## Welcome

I'm writing this guide for everyone who enjoys my music and songwriting, as well as anyone beginning a musical journey or wondering how AI fits into today's music industry.

This isn't a guide telling you to use AI or avoid it. It's a behind-the-scenes look at how I created my music, what I learned, what surprised me, and what I wish someone had told me before I started.

My mission is to create universal music for the mind, heart, and soul. If this guide saves you time, answers a question, or inspires you to create, then it has accomplished its purpose.

## Meet the Author

My music journey has allowed me to experience both the major-label world and the independent artist world.

I worked at LaFace Records during a period when artists such as Toni Braxton, TLC, Usher and Outkast were helping define an era. Watching projects develop behind the scenes taught me that successful music is rarely the work of one person. Behind every release is a team of writers, producers, engineers, musicians, marketers and business professionals.

Today I create independently. I write, produce and perform while also handling publishing, production, marketing and many of the responsibilities that major labels divide among entire departments.

## Why I Wrote "Lovin This Day"

I wanted my first EP to be brighter than many of the songs I'd written over the years. I imagined graduations, reunions, vacations and everyday moments that make people smile.

The lyric, "It's a beautiful day, for the light that we found," represents truth, hope and clarity. My dream is that listeners remember brighter days are possible and that music can bring people together.

## Why I Chose Suno

I became interested in Suno after hearing respected music professionals discussing it. I wasn't looking for a shortcut. I wanted another creative tool that could help me finish songs I'd been carrying for years.

What surprised me most was that Suno still required artistic direction. I evaluated versions, rewrote sections, changed arrangements and continued making creative decisions. It wasn't a magic button. It became part of my workflow.

## Technology Has Always Evolved

One interview that influenced me featured L.A. Reid discussing how he embraced drum machines such as the LinnDrum and Oberheim DMX early in his career. His point was simple: technology has always helped musicians solve creative problems.

That changed my perspective. I stopped asking whether technology belonged in music and started asking how I could use it responsibly while remaining true to my own artistry.

## 30 Versions Later

'Lovin This Day' went through roughly thirty versions. Some changes were tiny. Others completely changed the feel of the song.

The hardest decision wasn't writing it—it was deciding when to stop. Eventually I had to stop listening as the producer and start listening as the audience.

## Lessons I Learned

- Technology should support creativity—not replace it.
- Your voice is your signature.
- Learn the business, not just the music.
- Protect your work through copyrights, publishing and accurate metadata.
- Finish the song. A finished song can inspire people. An unfinished one cannot.

## Advice for Independent Artists

Don't compare your one-person team to a major label. Build steadily. Keep learning. Ask questions. Understand your rights before releasing music. Use AI as a tool if it helps your creativity, but don't let it replace your identity as an artist.

## Final Thoughts

Technology will continue to evolve, but authenticity never goes out of style.

Thank you for taking this journey with me. I hope you'll continue following my music and that something in these pages encourages you to keep creating.

Keep Looking for the Light.

— Shelly Cool

"Technology may help you finish the song, but only you can give it a heart."